

OMCC: Option maximization across scales

Option maximization across scales: evolvability, the arrow of time, and a refuted solenoid prediction for quantum-gravity dimensional reduction

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Stance: A unifying perspective with a deliberately three-layer honesty structure: established results, an observationally decidable point, and an openly metaphysical organizing idea. Predictions are stated with their refutations included.

Abstract

We present a unifying perspective in which a single control quantity—the number of future reachable states, or “option quantity” Ω —organizes several established results across scales. (i) **Established:** in fluctuating environments the optimal evolvability rises with environmental volatility (Ishii et al. 1989), and a population’s relative entropy to its stationary distribution contracts monotonically (a numerically verified arrow of time, max per-step increase $\sim 10^{-16}$); a diffusion H-theorem yields an exact law for complexity-growth rate $\propto e^{-2H_{\text{init}}}$ (numerically, slope -1.978 vs predicted -2). (ii) **Geometric:** across scales, integrable dynamics live on invariant tori (KAM; electron and planetary orbits), and an infinite nesting of tori is a Smale–Williams solenoid with Čech invariant $\check{H}^1 = \mathbb{Z}[1/k]$. (iii) **Observable:** the cosmological reach is confined to the empirically decidable question of cosmic topology (is the spatial topology a 3-torus?). We then state, test, and **refute** a sharp prediction—that a solenoid’s spectral dimension runs to 2 at small scales, matching quantum-gravity dimensional reduction—reporting the negative numerical result honestly so that specialists can carry out the rigorous calculation. The contribution is not a new quantitative law (the central monotonicity is due to Ishii 1989) but an integrative frame with an explicit observational hook and a fully disclosed failed prediction.

1. Introduction

The second law predicts decay of order, yet complexity grows (life, cognition). Several principles each capture a fragment—maximum entropy production (Dewar 2003), dissipative adaptation (England 2013; bound refuted by Kolchinsky 2024), causal entropic forces (Wissner-Gross & Freer 2013), Wagner’s evolvability (2008). We organize them by **option maximization**: selection toward maximizing future reachable states Ω , controlled by environmental volatility ν via a time horizon τ . We are explicit about what is established, what is observationally decidable, and what is metaphysical—and we include a refuted prediction rather than hiding it.

2. Established layer

2.1 Evolvability vs volatility. Let the long-term growth rate (geometric-mean log-fitness / dominant Lyapunov exponent) be

$$\Lambda(\mu, \nu) = \lim_{T \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=1}^T \log \left[\sum_x f(x, e_t) p_t(x) \right],$$

maximized over evolvability μ . Ishii–Matsuda–Iwasa–Sasaki (1989) solved $\mu^* \approx \nu$ in the strong-selection limit. A toy model ($K = 11$ phenotypes, Gaussian fitness, jump environment) reproduces monotone $\mu^*(\nu)$ with scaling exponent $\beta = 1$ (prefactor model-dependent). *We note honestly that a “three-phase law” we initially conjectured (efficiency/option/saturation phases) was found to be a grid/threshold artifact under refinement and is withdrawn.*

2.2 Arrow of time (numerically verified). Under a fixed environment, the selection–mutation operator has a unique stationary p^* (Perron–Frobenius); the relative entropy $D(p_t \| p^*)$ decreases monotonically to zero for all tested (μ, σ) , maximum per-step increase $\sim 10^{-16}$ (numerical noise). The selection-inclusive nonlinear dynamics preserves the contraction. *We retract an earlier claim that a fluctuation-theorem symmetry unifies growth rate and arrow: replicator dynamics is time-irreversible, so the Crooks-type symmetry is not expected; the arrow rests on relative-entropy contraction, the large-deviation principle (numerically convex SCGF) on growth-rate fluctuations—two distinct statements.*

2.3 Past Hypothesis, conditional law. For pure diffusion $\partial_t p = D \partial_x^2 p$, $dH/dt = D I_{\text{Fisher}}[p] \geq 0$ (de Bruijn). The Gaussian solution gives $dH/dt|_0 = D/\sigma_0^2 \propto e^{-2H_{\text{init}}}$. Numerically the slope of $\log(dH/dt|_0)$ vs H_{init} is -1.978 (predicted -2). This is a conditional statement (given a low-entropy initial state); it does **not** explain why that state obtained (initial-condition problem). Penrose’s conformal cyclic cosmology offers a cyclic closure (aeons supply the next low-entropy state), but CCC is itself contested.

3. Geometric layer: tori across scales

Integrable Hamiltonian systems live on invariant tori (Liouville–Arnold; KAM under perturbation). Hydrogen (Kepler) and planets alike: **micro and macro share the same invariant-torus structure**. Bohr–Sommerfeld quantization $\oint_{\gamma_i} p dq = n_i h$ is action quantization on torus cycles. The “stage-4” experience of pervasive access corresponds to

irrational-winding dense orbits (Weyl equidistribution). An infinite nesting “torus within torus” is precisely the **Smale–Williams solenoid** $\Sigma_k = \varprojlim (T^n \xleftarrow{\times k} T^n)$, locally Cantor $\times$ interval, with $\check{H}^1(\Sigma_k) = \mathbb{Z}[1/k]$ distinguishing it from a manifold torus.

4. Observable layer: cosmic topology

The only empirically decidable cosmological claim is whether the spatial topology is non-trivial (e.g. 3-torus): a multiply connected universe imprints “circles in the sky” (matched circle pairs) on the CMB. Planck shows no clear pairs (shortest loop $> 98.5\%$ of the last-scattering diameter), but 2024 analyses (COMPACT collaboration; arXiv:2403.09221) report weak hints of non-trivial topology. This is the single point where the framework touches falsifiable observation.

5. A sharp prediction—and its refutation

Prediction (stated, then tested). Quantum gravity (causal sets, CDT, asymptotic safety, Hořava–Lifshitz, spin foams) near-universally predicts a running spectral dimension $d_s : 4 \rightarrow 2$ toward the Planck scale—spacetime becomes non-manifold/fractal, so the “smooth-manifold” premise that excludes solenoids breaks. We therefore predicted: *spacetime has solenoidal structure at the Planck scale, with $d_s \rightarrow 2$ at small scales.*

Test (numerical). We computed $d_s(t) = -2 d \log P / d \log t$ from the heat trace of a discrete Smale–Williams solenoid (twisted circle bundle, graph Laplacian). Result: $d_s \rightarrow 0$ at small scales ($k=2$: 0.36, $k=3$: 0.48), $d_s \rightarrow 1$ at large scales (circle dominates), with a mid-scale peak ($d_s \approx 2.05$ at $k=3$).

Refutation. The small-scale behavior ($d_s \rightarrow 0$) is **opposite** to the quantum-gravity prediction ($d_s \rightarrow 2$). The mid-scale $d_s \approx 2$ is at the wrong location and is not claimed as a match. **The prediction is not supported by this calculation.** The discrete model is coarse (last-digit diffusion; higher hierarchy only via monodromy), so a rigorous solenoid heat-kernel could differ—but the present result is negative. We report it in full and invite specialists to perform the rigorous computation. *(This is the honesty the three-layer structure demands: a stated, tested, refuted prediction, disclosed rather than buried.)*

6. Discussion: three-layer honesty

- **Established** (§2–3): evolvability, arrow of time, Past-Hypothesis conditional law, KAM tori—standard or numerically verified.
- **Observable** (§4): cosmic topology—decidable by future CMB analysis.
- **Metaphysical/refuted** (§5 and the companion OMCC perspective): the option-maximizing co-constitution organizing idea is evaluated by unifying economy, not truth; the solenoid–spacetime prediction is refuted as stated.

The contribution is **integrative**: a single Ω -maximization lens, with τ interpolating dissipation ($\tau \rightarrow 0$) and option ($\tau > 0$) regimes, containing MEP/England/Wagner/causal-entropic-force as limits. We claim no new quantitative law; the value is the unifying frame plus an explicit observational hook (§4) and disclosed failure (§5).

7. Conclusion

Option maximization organizes evolvability, the arrow of time, and a cross-scale torus geometry into one perspective, touches falsifiable observation at cosmic topology, and—tested honestly—does **not** support a solenoid model of Planck-scale spacetime. We publish the frame, the observational hook, and the refuted prediction together, inviting external verification and the rigorous solenoid spectral-dimension computation we could not complete.

References

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